

Entrecote au Paivre et Roquefort (Peppered Steak with Roquefort Cheese)

Makes 2 servings.

Steak

- 2 New York strip steaks, 12 ounces each**
- Salt**
- 1 tablespoon cracked black peppercorns**
- 1 tablespoon coarsely ground coriander seeds**
- 2 tablespoons butter**
- 1 tablespoon vegetable oil**

Sauce

- 1 teaspoon minced shallots**
- 1/8 teaspoon cracked peppercorns**
- 1/4 cup dry white wine**
- 1 cup beef broth**
- 1 teaspoon butter**
- Pinch of minced garlic**
- 2 drops lemon juice**
- Salt and pepper**
- 2 tablespoons Roquefort cheese**

Steak: Preheat the broiler. Lightly salt the steaks.

Combine the peppercorns and coriander. Using the heel of your hand, firmly press the mixture into both sides of each steak.

Heat the butter and oil in a heavy skillet. When the butter begins to brown, add the steaks and cook over moderately high heat until they are browned on both sides. Allow 3 minutes per side for medium rare.

Remove steaks and place on a platter, keeping them warm while you prepare the sauce.

Sauce: Wipe out the saucepan in which the steaks were prepared. Then put in the shallots, peppercorns and wine and place over high heat. Let the mixture reduce until it is almost dry. Add the beef broth and bring to a boil. Remove from the heat and stir in the butter with a whisk. Add the garlic and lemon juice. Taste and adjust seasonings.

When ready to serve, place 1 tablespoon of cheese, broken into 4 or 5 pieces, on top of each steak.

Place the steaks under the broiler until the cheese begins to melt. Remove the steaks from the broiler and pour the sauce around them. Serve at once.

Recipe supplied by restaurant; tested by members of the Junior element of the Tidewater Chef's Association, American Culinary Federation and Johnson and Wales University College of Culinary Arts